

Guillermo Fernando Farfán Romero

Senior Cloud Architect & DevOps Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Cloud Architect and DevOps Engineer with 8+ years of experience spearheading the design, automation, resilience, and financial optimization (FinOps) of mission-critical infrastructure on **Google Cloud Platform (GCP)**, **Kubernetes orchestration (GKE Autopilot/Standard)**, and Infrastructure as Code (**Terraform / Terragrunt** with remote state locking).

Specialist in Platform Engineering (Internal Developer Platforms - IDP), enterprise cloud migrations (SAP on SLES 15), GitOps workflows (**ArgoCD**), full-stack observability with **IBM Instana APM / OpenTelemetry**, and DevSecOps pipelines aligned with DORA metrics. Combines deep technical architecture and high-availability systems design with strategic team leadership, backed by a dual background in Information Systems and Labor Relations.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

- **Cloud Providers:** Google Cloud Platform (Core Specialist: GKE Autopilot/Standard, Compute Engine, Cloud Run, Cloud Storage, VPC Peering, Cloud Armor WAF, Zero-Trust IAM, Cloud Interconnect, Filestore, Secret Manager), Microsoft Azure.
- **IaC & GitOps:** Terraform (Reusable Modules, Remote Backends, GCS State Locking), Terragrunt, ArgoCD, Helm Charts, Kustomize, Ansible, TFLint, Checkov, Infracost, Bash Scripting, Python (Automation & APIs).
- **Containers & Orchestration:** Kubernetes (GKE, kubectl, Ingress Controllers, Horizontal Pod Autoscaler - HPA, NetworkPolicies, Service Mesh), Docker, Docker Compose, Platform Engineering & IDP.
- **CI/CD & DevSecOps:** GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Google Secret Manager, HashiCorp Vault, Trunk-Based Development, SemVer, Trivy, SonarQube (SAST/DAST), Security Gates in CI/CD.
- **Observability, SRE & FinOps:** IBM Instana APM (Distributed Tracing, Host/K8s Sensors), OpenTelemetry (OTel), Google Cloud Operations (Monitoring/Logging), Prometheus, Grafana, SLOs/SLIs, DORA Metrics, FinOps Foundation Framework.
- **Systems & Networking:** Linux (SUSE Linux Enterprise Server - SLES 15 SP7 for SAP, Ubuntu, Red Hat), XFS, LVM, Hybrid Networking, DNS/DHCP (Infoblox NIOS), Cloud NAT, VPN Interconnect.
- **Databases & Persistence:** Cloud SQL (PostgreSQL, MySQL), Microsoft SQL Server, Redis, BigQuery, MongoDB.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Lead & Senior Systems Engineer (Platform / DevOps Focus) | Reforest Latam

May 2024 – Present | Full-time (Remote)

- **Spearheaded cloud financial optimization (FinOps) on Google Cloud Platform** for environmental telemetry platforms, resizing compute instances and configuring elastic autoscaling to achieve a **sustained 28% reduction in monthly cloud infrastructure spend**.
- **Architected and implemented a cloud-native GitOps pipeline on GKE Autopilot and Cloud Run** using GitHub Actions and continuous reconciliation with ArgoCD, **slashing deployment lead times from 5 days to minutes (Zero-Downtime)**.
- **Enforced a Zero-Trust security posture on GCP** through fine-grained least-privilege IAM policies, dedicated Service Accounts, and Cloud Armor WAF rules, mitigating DDoS vectors and unauthorized access.
- **Integrated automated container security scans using Trivy and SonarQube into CI/CD pipelines**, ensuring **100% of production container images are free of critical and high-severity vulnerabilities**.
- **Led and mentored a platform engineering team of 6**, establishing Architecture Decision Records (ADRs), continuous code reviews, and agile Scrum workflows.

Senior Cloud Architect & DevOps Consultant | Independent Consulting & Enterprise Projects

January 2021 – Present | Strategic B2B Technology Consultant (Independent / Contract / Remote)

- **Engineered standardized, reusable Terraform modules** for private VPC topologies, subnets, firewalls, Secret Manager, and Cloud SQL, **cutting enterprise infrastructure provisioning time by 70%**.
- **Implemented distributed real-time observability using IBM Instana APM and OpenTelemetry** for end-to-end transaction tracing across retail, mining, and healthcare enterprise clients, **achieving a 45% reduction in MTTR (Mean Time to Resolution)**.
- **Led enterprise SAP infrastructure migration to GCP**, automating VM provisioning on SLES 15 SP7 for SAP CAR Rise with Terraform and optimizing XFS/LVM storage layouts for high I/O throughput.
- **Standardized multi-environment governance (Dev, QA, Prod)** by deploying **GKE Autopilot** clusters (`us-east1`) with NetworkPolicies, Ingress controllers, and Horizontal Pod Autoscaling (HPA).
- **Designed and executed disaster recovery (DRP) and network migration plans** for 12 DNS domains and 283 DHCP subnets utilizing Infoblox NIOS under high-availability topologies.

Senior Software Engineer & Database Administrator | University of Buenos Aires (UBA)

March 2018 – February 2024 | Institutional Systems Specialist (Part-time / Buenos Aires, Argentina)

- **Architected High Availability (HA) replication and automated backup strategies across 8+ TB of mission-critical institutional data** (+50,000 active users), guaranteeing **strict compliance with RPO < 15 min and RTO < 1 hour**.
- **Automated infrastructure operations and maintenance routines with Bash and Python scripts**, achieving a **60% reduction in manual operational workload** across heterogeneous Linux and Windows environments.
- **Performed continuous security hardening and database administration** on high-demand SQL Server and PostgreSQL instances, ensuring transactional integrity and operational uptime.

Systems Infrastructure & Operations Coordinator | Government of the City of Buenos Aires (GCBA)

January 2020 – December 2023 | Full-time (Buenos Aires, Argentina)

- **Guaranteed 99.9% operational database and infrastructure uptime (SLA)** across municipal citizen portals serving 100,000+ monthly users.
- **Achieved zero unplanned downtime** across core public service systems by coordinating scheduled maintenance windows, controlled releases, and proactive monitoring.

EDUCATION

- **Associate Degree in Information Systems** | National Technological University (UTN) (*In Progress — Expected Graduation: December 2026*)
- **Bachelor's Degree in Labor Relations & Human Resources** | University of Buenos Aires (UBA) (*Graduated — Focus on Organizational Leadership, Talent Strategy & High-Performance Team Dynamics*)

KEY CERTIFICATIONS (VERIFIABLE ON CREDLY)

- **Official Industry Certifications (Proctored Exams):** Google Cloud Certified Associate Cloud Engineer (ACE) | GitHub Foundations Certified | Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900).
- **Accredited Professional Specializations:** IBM Instana Observability & APM Specialist | IBM DevOps and Software Engineering Professional Certificate | Meta Backend Developer Professional Certificate.

LANGUAGES

- **Spanish:** Native
- **English:** Full Professional Proficiency (C1 / Full technical fluency for cloud architecture design, live engineering syncs, RFCs, and technical documentation)